UNIT 2: KNOW YOURSELF

TOPIC 3: WORK VALUES

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Understand how values influence behavior and choices
- Identify their work values and will use this information to identify careers of interest

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Have their results from an online career interest assessment (**O*NET Work Importance Locator**) via **Mass CIS,** which they can use to narrow down career clusters/areas of interest, and discover occupations that match their profile
- Add a completed **O*NET Work Importance Locator** to their Student Career Portfolio

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Large Group Discussion

Objectives:
- Students will identify and understand the meaning of work values, and how they can shape behavior.
- Students will explore how their work values can be a tool for finding a satisfying job/career.

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: Pens/pencils, chalkboard/chalk or chart paper/markers

Ask the students to name some values (make suggestions if the group needs help getting started — helping people, being creative, working as a team, taking on challenges, sense of security, working alone, etc.), and write them on chart paper or a chalk board. Explain that values are things that you find important, and that they often guide behavior. Ask for examples of a corresponding behavior for each of the values listed.

A quick "show of hands" poll could be conducted for each of the values listed to show that different people have different value systems, even though they can overlap with others. Have students suggest which of the values listed could be considered "work values" or things that would be important for satisfaction on the job, and circle those. See if students can generate any more "work values" for the list.

Writing/Reflection/Assessment

Objective: Students will identify their own set of "work values" and be able to organize them by importance.

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Work Values Worksheets,"** pens/pencils

Hand out the **"Work Values Worksheet,"** and explain that this work is to give more ideas of "work values." Ask students to categorize them by their importance to them. The work values that have the highest scores are ones that should be emphasized in a career search, as they will increase chances for good job performance and personal satisfaction. If time, have students answer the reflective questions at the end of the exercise.

Technical (Mass CIS)/Research

Objective: Students will participate in a detailed, online career assessment, that will focus on "work values" and specific careers. Students will keep this information in paper and online portfolios for future reference.

Time: 25 minutes

Materials: Computers with internet connection, note cards for names and passwords, pens/pencils, printer to print out individual results for portfolio

Have students log onto **Mass CIS** and click on the **"Work Importance Locator,"** link under the Assessment Tools heading in the lower left corner. The Assessment is self-explanatory, but some students may require staff assistance. After students have completed the assessment and explored related jobs, have them save their results to their **Mass CIS** portfolio, their electronic portfolio, and print a copy for their paper portfolio.

MY VALUES

The fit between your values and the rewards in the job affects how happy you are in your job. Also how well you perform on the job is affected by how happy you are with the job. So, when exploring careers, it is useful to look at your values because using your values in your work will satisfy you and perhaps enhance your job performance.

For the purposes of this activity, a value is something that ***you*** consider important and something that influences the way **you**, and you alone, think and act. Read the twenty values concepts below and think about your ideal job. Next, organize these values into the five categories depicted by the table headers below. Finally, answer the questions at the bottom of this page. Take your time, be honest, and enjoy yourself.

VALUES CONCEPTS

1. Making use of my abilities
2. Treated fairly by the business
3. Busy all the time
4. Opportunity for advancement
5. Give directions and instructions to others
6. Provide feeling of accomplishment
7. Pay compares well with co-workers
8. Co-workers easy to get along with
9. Try out my own ideas
10. Work alone
11. Never be pressured to do things against my beliefs
12. Recognition for the work I do
13. Make my own decisions
14. Steady employment
15. Do things for others
16. Supervisors back me up to management
17. Supervisors who train workers well
18. Do something different every day
19. Good working conditions
20. Plan my own work; little supervision

Importance Scale **Most Important----------Least Important** **5**	**4**	**3**	**2**	**1**

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How did you come to possess these values?

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How do your values affect the decisions that you make?

_____

How do your top five values influence your career plans?

_____

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_____

Now, go use the Work Importance Locator and carefully read the interpretations to learn more about how your values relate to occupations.

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